ENGLISH C1 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Complex reporting verbs

Report positions with verbs that encode acceptance, denial, accusation, concession and insistence through different complement patterns. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use complex reporting verbs to summarise not only what was said but the speaker's communicative act and stance while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Report positions with verbs that encode acceptance, denial, accusation, concession and insistence through different complement patterns.

MODEL

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.

reporting verb + that/-ing/object + preposition

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main complex reporting verbs patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses summarise not only what was said but the speaker's communicative act and stance.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in academic synthesis, journalism, minutes and legal or professional reporting.

Build meaning before form

Report positions with verbs that encode acceptance, denial, accusation, concession and insistence through different complement patterns.

What complex reporting verbs communicates

Report positions with verbs that encode acceptance, denial, accusation, concession and insistence through different complement patterns.

The central purpose is to summarise not only what was said but the speaker's communicative act and stance. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.	acceptance of a limitation within an argument
The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.	a reported allegation directed at a specific actor
The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.	a firm demand or maintained position

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: reporting verb + that/-ing/object + preposition. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model "The authors concede that the sample may be too small." shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Concession	concede/acknowledge + that-clause	The authors concede that the sample may be too small.
Accusation	accuse + object + of + -ing	The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.
Insistence	insist + on + -ing / that-clause	The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
acceptance of a limitation within an argument	Concession
a reported allegation directed at a specific actor	Accusation
a firm demand or maintained position	Insistence

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in academic synthesis, journalism, minutes and legal or professional reporting. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03
reporting verb	that/-ing/object	preposition

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: summarise not only what was said but the speaker's communicative act and stance.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits academic synthesis, journalism, minutes and legal or professional reporting.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Concession	concede/acknowledge + that-clause	The authors concede that the sample may be too small.
Accusation	accuse + object + of + -ing	The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.
Insistence	insist + on + -ing / that-clause	The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.	acceptance of a limitation within an argument
The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.	a reported allegation directed at a specific actor
The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.	a firm demand or maintained position

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use a stronger reporting verb than the source justifies.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use accuse that; include an object and of.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use insist to receiving.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: acceptance of a limitation within an argument?

OPTIONS The authors concede that the sample may be too small. · The regulator accused the firm of withholding information. · The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a reported allegation directed at a specific actor?

OPTIONS The regulator accused the firm of withholding information. · The client insisted on receiving a written explanation. · The authors concede that the sample may be too small.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a firm demand or maintained position?

OPTIONS The client insisted on receiving a written explanation. · The authors concede that the sample may be too small. · The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The authors concede that the sample may be too small.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS acceptance of a limitation within an argument · a reported allegation directed at a specific actor · a firm demand or maintained position

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a reported allegation directed at a specific actor · a firm demand or maintained position · acceptance of a limitation within an argument

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a firm demand or maintained position · acceptance of a limitation within an argument · a reported allegation directed at a specific actor

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

02 · PRACTICE STAGE

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“The authors concede that the sample may be too small.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Concession / Accusation / Insistence · Gap 2: acceptance of a limitation within an argument / a reported allegation directed at a specific actor / a firm demand or maintained position

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Accusation / Insistence / Concession · Gap 2: a reported allegation directed at a specific actor / a firm demand or maintained position / acceptance of a limitation within an argument

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Insistence / Concession / Accusation · Gap 2: a firm demand or maintained position / acceptance of a limitation within an argument / a reported allegation directed at a specific actor

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

03 · PRACTICE STAGE

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses acceptance of a limitation within an argument: _____. Choose the model that expresses a reported allegation directed at a specific actor: _____. Choose the model that expresses a firm demand or maintained position: _____. Choose the model built with concede/acknowledge + that-clause: _____. Choose the model built with accuse + object + of + -ing: _____. Choose the model built with insist + on + -ing / that-clause: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The authors concede that the sample may be too small. · The client insisted on receiving a written explanation. · The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The authors _____ the sample may be too small. The regulator _____ information. The client _____ a written explanation. State the full structural pattern for Concession: _____. State the full structural pattern for Accusation: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The authors admit the sample may be too small.” using the Concession pattern to express acceptance of a limitation within an argument.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The regulator alleged that the firm withheld information.” using the Accusation pattern to express a reported allegation directed at a specific actor.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “The client firmly demanded a written explanation.” using the Insistence pattern to express a firm demand or maintained position.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The authors admit the sample may be too small.” using the Concession pattern to express acceptance of a limitation within an argument.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Concession to express acceptance of a limitation within an argument, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Accusation to express a reported allegation directed at a specific actor, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Insistence to express a firm demand or maintained position, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.

Concession is the best match because acceptance of a limitation within an argument.

A2

The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.

Accusation is the best match because a reported allegation directed at a specific actor.

A3

The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.

Insistence is the best match because a firm demand or maintained position.

A4

acceptance of a limitation within an argument

The Concession pattern communicates acceptance of a limitation within an argument.

A5

a reported allegation directed at a specific actor

The Accusation pattern communicates a reported allegation directed at a specific actor.

A6

a firm demand or maintained position

The Insistence pattern communicates a firm demand or maintained position.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Concession / acceptance of a limitation within an argument

The structure belongs to the Concession pattern. Its communicative purpose is acceptance of a limitation within an argument.

B2

Accusation / a reported allegation directed at a specific actor

The structure belongs to the Accusation pattern. Its communicative purpose is a reported allegation directed at a specific actor.

B3

Insistence / a firm demand or maintained position

The structure belongs to the Insistence pattern. Its communicative purpose is a firm demand or maintained position.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.

Concession: concede/acknowledge + that-clause.

C2

The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.

Accusation: accuse + object + of + -ing.

C3

The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.

Insistence: insist + on + -ing / that-clause.

C4

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.

Concession: concede/acknowledge + that-clause.

C5

The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.

Accusation: accuse + object + of + -ing.

C6

The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.

Insistence: insist + on + -ing / that-clause.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

concede that

Concession requires “concede that” in this model. concede/acknowledge + that-clause.

D2

accused the firm of withholding

Accusation requires “accused the firm of withholding” in this model. accuse + object + of + -ing.

D3

insisted on receiving

Insistence requires “insisted on receiving” in this model. insist + on + -ing / that-clause.

D4

concede/acknowledge + that-clause

Concession is built as concede/acknowledge + that-clause.

D5

accuse + object + of + -ing

Accusation is built as accuse + object + of + -ing.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.

concede/acknowledge + that-clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended concession effect.

E2

The regulator accused the firm of withholding information.

accuse + object + of + -ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended accusation effect.

E3

The client insisted on receiving a written explanation.

insist + on + -ing / that-clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended insistence effect.

E4

The authors concede that the sample may be too small.

concede/acknowledge + that-clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended concession effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The authors concede that the sample may be too small. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses concede/acknowledge + that-clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The regulator accused the firm of withholding information. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses accuse + object + of + -ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The client insisted on receiving a written explanation. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses insist + on + -ing / that-clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____